The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "The Armlet on the Crest of the Banner"

Āryadhvajāgrakeyūranāmadhāraṇī · Toh 923 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་རྒྱལ་མཚན་གཙུག་རྒྱན་དཔུང་རྒྱན་ཅས་བ་བྱའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "The Armlet on the Crest of the Banner," known in Sanskrit as the Āryadhvajāgrakeyūra-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as 'Phags pa rgyal mtshan gyi rtse mo'i dpung rgyan ces bya ba'i gzungs, is a short scripture centered on a protective incantation. It opens in the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, where the Buddha is seated on a stone slab as white as wool. Śakra, lord of the gods, comes to him in haste and distress after he and the gods have been utterly defeated in battle by Vemacitrin, lord of the asuras. In response, the Buddha teaches a dhāraṇī meant to be worn or carried as an armlet or fixed atop a banner, conferring protection and victory over adversaries. The work is Toh 923 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts, the class of scriptures devoted to sacred formulas recited for protection and blessing.

In the language of India: ārya dhvaja agra keyūra nāma dhāraṇī

In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "The Armlet on the Crest of the Banner."

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling among the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, seated on the stone slab that is like white wool. Then Śakra, lord of the gods, was defeated by the asuras, utterly defeated. In a hurried and agitated state he went to where the Blessed One was. When he arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and said to him:

"Blessed One, when I went into battle with the asuras, as has now happened, I was defeated by Vemacitrin, lord of the asuras, utterly defeated, and the gods of the Thirty-Three were also defeated, utterly defeated. Blessed One, how should we act in this situation?"

The Blessed One said, "Lord of the gods, take up the dhāraṇī called the Armlet on the Crest of the Banner, which others cannot overcome. Long ago, when I was a bodhisattva, I too received it from the tathāgata Aparājitadhvaja. Having received it, I explained it correctly and extensively to others. I remember that from that time on I have never experienced fear, terror, or hair standing on

end, nor has my body suffered harm even for an instant, even for a moment."

"Blessed One, what is this dhāraṇī called the Armlet on the Crest of the Banner, which others cannot overcome?"

The Blessed One said:

tadyathā oṃ jaya jaya vijaya vijaya jayavāhini śaṅkari śaṅkari prabhaṃkari of myself and all sentient beings sarvaśatrūṃ jambhaya jambhaya stambhaya stambhaya mohaya mohaya bhagavate jayavāhini matha matha pramatha pramatha grasa grasa hasa hasa hūṃ hūṃ lahūṃ lahūṃ lambodari trinetre caturavāktre catudadaṃṣṭe caturbhuje asimusala cakratriśūla vajrakavacadhāraṇi protect me from all harm, protect me!

oṃ bhagavati hana hana daha daha paca paca matha matha pramatha pramatha dhuna dhuna vidhuna vidhuna hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ bhañja bhañja parasainyaṃ vidhānsaya sarvaśatrūṃ nāśaya dhvajaagrakeyūre triṭa triṭa triṭa bhriṭa bhriṭa ulkāmukhi ulkādhāraṇī trailokyamathāni vidhvansaya parasainyana protect me from all harm, protect me!

cala cala cili cili culu culu kaṃpa kaṃpa kala kala kili kili kulu kulu muñca muñca aṭṭahāsaṃ vidhvansaya parasainyan protect me from all harm, protect me!

trāsaya trāsaya bhrāmaya bhrāmaya buddhasatyena dharmasatyena saṃghasatyena satyavādināṃ satyena buddhasatyemātikrama dharmasatyemātikrama saṃghasatyemātikrama satyavādināṃ satyamātikrama lambodari lambodari kuṭa kuṭa kuṭṭa kuṭṭa kuṭṭa kuṭṭāvaya kuṭṭāpaya rudramanāya viṣṇumanāya candrasūryaprahmamanāya trailokyaadhipatimanāya sarvadevaadhipatimanāya sarvayakṣarākṣasa ganadharva kuṃbhaṇḍa mahoragaadhipatimanāya vidhvansaya parasainyaṃ raṃga raṃga raṃgāpaya raṃgāpaya jvāla jvāla puṣpamālini rundha rundha riti riti citi citi dhriti dhriti bhṛkuṭimukhapara senakulotsādanikari hala hala hili hili hulu hulu he he riṇi riṇi riṇimati jaṃbhadhvaje sarvabuddha avalokite protect me from all fears, protect me!

sarvatathāgata avalokite svāhā guṇarājaprabhāsottame svāhā sūryaarkavimale svāhā candraarkavimale svāhā sarvagrahanakṣatradhemīkaraṇe svāhā protect me from all fears, harms, contagious diseases, and disturbances, protect me! svāhā

"King of the gods, through this dhāraṇī called the Armlet on the Crest of the Banner, which others cannot overcome, whether you engage in battle,

combat, dispute, or conflict, wherever you may go, you will be fearless and victorious in every way. If it is tied to the crest of a banner or worn at the neck, it protects kings of men and all heroic warriors. Transforming itself into the form of a woman, it stands before them, granting fearlessness and giving protection. It increases glory. It humbles the enemy's armies. It causes auspiciousness, purity, fame, glory, and excellence to abide always."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Śakra, lord of the gods, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This concludes the Noble Dhāraṇī Called "The Armlet on the Crest of the Banner."

It was translated and edited by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla and the chief editor and translator, the monk Yeshé Dé. It was then revised according to the new terminology and finalized.

Translator's Notes

• The "stone slab like white wool" is the Pāṇḍukambala stone in the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, where the Buddha taught. In the passage on its benefits, the Tibetan gives no explicit subject for "transforming into the form of a woman." I take the dhāraṇī itself, personified as a goddess, as the subject and render it "it."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.